



Fitdog Enrichment at Home

Better Walks Planning Guide



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Better Walks Through Sniffing

Let sniffing be the point.

Sometimes the best walk is not the longest walk. It is the walk that lets your dog decompress.

TRAINER NOTE

If your dog finishes puzzles instantly, increase difficulty slowly — or add sniffing.

Start here

Dog's name

Date

Owner

Best reward

Daily outlets

Sniffing, chewing, and problem-solving are needs — not extras.

Match difficulty

Enrichment should engage, not frustrate.

Track engagement

A better walk gives your dog information, movement, and decompression.

1 Training goal

YOUR GOAL THIS WEEK

A better walk gives your dog information, movement, and decompression.

2 Lesson focus checklist

- ☐ Why sniffing matters
- ☐ Sniff breaks as rewards
- ☐ Walk planning
- ☐ Structured walks versus decompression walks
- ☐ Reducing leash frustration

Supplies needed

- Harness (leash)
- Notebook (optional)



PRACTICE · TRACK

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Plan one decompression walk: loose leash, no strict heel, sniffing allowed.

Mark and treat when your dog chooses to sniff — that is the reward.

Use a sniff break after a structured training rep on your next walk.

Compare: one structured walk vs. one sniff-focused walk. Log your dog's energy after.

Write one route change that gives your dog more sniff opportunities.

4 Practice tracker

Date	Walk type	Duration	Sniff time	Notes
Day 1	Decompression	20 min	Most of walk	Calmer after



REVIEW · REFLECT

5 Common mistakes to avoid

AVOID THESE

- Using enrichment only when the dog is already destructive.
- Puzzles that are too hard — frustration, not fulfillment.
- Every walk is a strict heel — no sniff time at all.

If this happens, try this

IF THIS HAPPENS, TRY THIS

• If your dog loses interest, make it easier or use higher-value food.
 • If your dog struggles after enrichment — tired, fulfilled, still stuck difficulty. Contact Fitdog if safety is a concern.

6 Ready to progress?

- ☐ I can explain "Better Walks Through Sniffing" clearly.
- ☐ I added at least one new enrichment activity this week.
- ☐ I ended sessions while my dog was still engaged.
- ☐ My dog had daily outlets for sniffing, chewing, or problem-solving.

Practice one skill from "Better Walks Through Sniffing" three times this week. Note what to simplify.

What went well?

When did my dog struggle?

Questions for my Fitdog trainer:

WELFARE / SAFETY

Supervise new enrichment setups. Remove items your dog could swallow or destroy unsafely.